

Recommended Buys

From the best smartphone to ultrabooks, we recommend the right products for you to buy

Price Watch

We give you the latest price roundup of Kids tablets, high-end TVs and then some. Go on, the price is right.

Business Laptops

Buying laptops for professional, business or office-related use isn't the same as buying a regular laptop. At times, business laptops are better than mainstream laptops. Here's how:

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Business laptops are different than mainstream consumer laptops in more ways than one. Don't be hassled, it's not a big deal. I will point out the basic things you need to keep in mind when you're trying to buy a laptop for work. Apart from telling you what to look for, I'll also impress upon you specs that matter and specs that don't.

Business laptops are generally built better than mainstream laptops, but they're notorious for having an industrial, lacklustre look and feel. Some of the best business laptops from brands like Lenovo, HP, Acer, Dell all look the same – they're either various shades of black with a splash of gunmetal accents. The better looking business laptops are priced higher than average-looking business laptops, even if their specs are the same. If you're going to try and make an impression in a boardroom meeting with your peers, investing in a trendy looking, polished piece of laptop makes a lot of sense. A powerbook to go with your power suit – I get it. I think the Dell Precision M3800 is one of the best-looking business laptop I've laid my eyes on in the past year.



More than its hardware, a business laptop's built-in proprietary software is one that matters most – that's what separates it from mainstream consumer notebooks to a greater degree. Stuff like backup and restore apps, hardware maintenance and diagnostics tools, data encryption software, security suite (which doesn't just include your average antivirus but something more than what you get on most laptops), password manager, battery power manager, and other tools. Lenovo's ThinkPads, for instance, are all equipped with Lenovo's ThinkVantage software suite, which makes a ThinkPad's maintenance all the more convenient over the long run. Brands like HP, Dell, Acer and Toshiba also have built-in software utilities that's actually useful.

From a usability perspective, a business laptop tries to incorporate features like spill-resistant, backlit keys, and even a trackpoint. From a security standpoint, needless to say, the security and integ-

riety of a business laptop is of paramount importance. To protect the sensitive data that a business laptop may hold, manufacturers equip these machines with a TPM chip. A trusted platform module embedded in a laptop's motherboard ensures that all its data is encrypted and secured at its hardware level, independent of any software installed on it.

When it comes to accessories, some business laptops come with at least a battery expansion slot – which can come very handy after your device's primary bundled battery starts becoming less efficient. The slightly more expensive business laptops also have dock support – we know machines from Dell, HP and Lenovo that support docks which further enhance the appeal of the laptops. Docks can add extra connectivity ports (USB, DisplayPort, etc), can cool the laptop connected to it, and do so much more.

Warranty and support matters. Most business laptops come with a standard